PassFrame
TUITION

Autumn's Arrival

Year 4 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Poetry

Extract (poem) — read it carefully before answering

The leaves begin to turn and fall,
like golden coins from branches tall,
and scatter soft across the ground,
a crunching, rustling, russet sound.

The air grows sharp, the mornings grey,
and breath hangs white and drifts away;
the swallows gather, wing to wing,
preparing for their journeying.

The squirrel hides his hoarded store
of acorns, counted three times more,
while hedgehogs curl in leafy beds
and tuck their noses, sleepy heads.

The harvest moon hangs low and round,
a lantern lit above the ground,
and farmers gather in the grain
before the coming autumn rain.

So though the summer's warmth has fled,
and softer light hangs low instead,
there's beauty too in fading light,
in amber days and quiet night.

Questions

20 min · 12 questions

1. What happens to the leaves in the first verse?

2. Name two creatures mentioned preparing for the colder season.

3. Underline the line that tells you the mornings have become cold.

4. Underline the simile that describes the falling leaves.

5. What does “hoarded” suggest about the way the squirrel keeps his acorns?

6. True or false: the poem describes summer arriving, not autumn.

7. Why do you think the poet describes the swallows as “wing to wing”?

8. What does the farmer do in the fourth verse, and why might this be happening now?

9. In your own words, explain what the final verse suggests about the poet's feelings towards autumn.

10. What does the phrase “a lantern lit above the ground” suggest about how the poet sees the harvest moon?

11. Why do you think the poet chose to end the poem with the idea of “beauty… in fading light”?

12. Do you think autumn is a sad or a hopeful season, based on this poem? Explain your answer using evidence.